Food Service Associate

Food & Nutrition Services · Support Services

Job title	Food Service Associate	**Job code**	JD-HRM-094
Department	Food & Nutrition Services	**Division**	Support Services
Grade	FS1	**Reports to**	Food Service Supervisor / Catering Manager
Supervises	None	**SCFHS licence**	No

Job Summary

Provides food-service support within the Food and Nutrition Services department at Almather Hospital — assembling, distributing, and collecting patient meal trays according to prescribed diets, and maintaining food-safety and hygiene standards — under the supervision of the Food Service Supervisor. Contributes to safe, accurate, and timely patient meal service.

Essential Duties & Responsibilities

1. Assembles patient meal trays accurately according to prescribed diet orders, meal tickets, and portion standards, verifying each tray against the patient's name, room number, and diet type.
2. Distributes meal trays to patients on the assigned units at scheduled meal times, confirming patient identity before serving and assisting with tray placement.
3. Collects used trays, dishes, and utensils after meals and returns them to the dishwashing area for cleaning and sanitising.
4. Prepares and serves beverages, snacks, and between-meal nourishments, and ensures fresh drinking water is available to patients as directed.
5. Verifies special, therapeutic, and texture-modified diets with the diet office or Clinical Dietitian, and reports discrepancies or patient dietary concerns to the supervisor or nursing staff.
6. Operates and maintains food-service equipment (trolleys, warmers, refrigerators, dishwashers) safely, and reports malfunctions to the supervisor.
7. Monitors and records food and refrigerator temperatures, and adheres to cold-chain and food-safety (HACCP) requirements at all times.
8. Maintains cleanliness and sanitation of the kitchen, pantry, tray line, and service areas in line with infection-control and food-hygiene standards.
9. Receives, checks, stores, and rotates food and supply deliveries (FIFO), and maintains stock levels of pantry and service items.
10. Segregates and disposes of food and general waste correctly, and follows all environmental and safety procedures.
11. Adheres to personal-hygiene, hand-hygiene, and PPE requirements for food handlers, and maintains a valid food-handler health certificate.
12. Communicates respectfully with patients, families, and the healthcare team, and maintains patient privacy, dignity, and confidentiality at all times.
13. Follows all hospital and department policies and procedures, participates in on-job training, and performs other related duties as assigned.

Qualifications: Education, Training & Experience

1. Education — High School Diploma or equivalent is required. Completion of a food-service, catering, or food-hygiene training course is preferred.
2. Experience — No experience is required (on-job training provided). Previous food-service or hospital catering experience is preferred.
3. Licence / Certification — Valid food-handler health certificate is required (to be obtained within the probationary period). Basic food-safety/HACCP training preferred. No SCFHS licensure required. Ability to communicate in Arabic and/or English is required.

Skills

1. Food Service: Meal-tray assembly, diet verification and safe food handling.
2. Communication: Clear communication with patients and the nursing team.
3. Teamwork: Effective collaboration under supervisor direction.
4. Food Safety: HACCP, temperature monitoring and hygiene compliance.
5. Technology: Basic use of meal-ordering/diet systems and equipment.
6. Organisation: Task prioritization and documentation.

Knowledge

1. Meal-tray assembly, diet-order verification and portion standards.
2. Food-safety and hygiene practices (HACCP), cold-chain and temperature monitoring.
3. Therapeutic and texture-modified diet types and patient meal service.
4. Knowledge of GDIPC Infection Prevention & Control standards and hand-hygiene practice.
5. Knowledge of patient rights, confidentiality and the hospital Code of Conduct.
6. Knowledge of applicable KSA food-safety and healthcare regulations relevant to the role.

Attitude & Behaviour

1. Respect & Integrity
2. Patient-Centred Approach
3. Accountability
4. Continuous Learning
5. Teamwork & Collaboration
6. Confidentiality
7. Professionalism
8. Adaptability & Resilience
9. Compassion & Empathy
10. Commitment to Safety

Physical Requirements

- Prolonged standing and walking during shifts.
- Ability to lift/assist patients and equipment (up to ~20 kg) with safe technique.
- Manual dexterity for clinical/technical procedures.

- Use of personal protective equipment (PPE); potential exposure to clinical hazards.
- Shift work, night shifts and on-call duties as required by the unit.

Approval

Reviewed & recommended by	Department Head	**Approved by**	HR Manager

Staff acknowledgement and signature are recorded electronically through the AMH Staff Credentials Portal.